

THE LAST LANTERN

A Short Film Screenplay

Written by Alex Morgan

STUDIOPILOT AI — DEMO SCRIPT

Created specifically to test screenplay document extraction.

FADE IN:

A cold autumn rain falls over the coastal town of Bellhaven. The streets are almost empty. At the end of Harbor Road, an old lighthouse stands against the dark sea.

A brass LIGHTHOUSE LANTERN flickers in the upper window.

CUT TO:

1. INT. LIGHTHOUSE — LANTERN ROOM — NIGHT

MAYA REYES, 28, a marine engineer with a worn backpack, climbs the narrow iron stairs. She carries a FLASHLIGHT and a small TOOLBOX.

The great Fresnel lens turns slowly. The light skips across Maya's face.

MAYA

Hello?

No answer. Maya opens the toolbox and removes a screwdriver.

MAYA

Come on. Not tonight.

A metallic CLANG echoes below.

2. EXT. BELLHAVEN HARBOR — NIGHT

DANIEL REYES, 32, Maya's older brother, runs along the wet pier. He wears a yellow raincoat and carries a RED MARINE RADIO.

Daniel looks toward the lighthouse.

DANIEL

Maya! Turn it off and come down!

The lighthouse beam sweeps over him. The radio crackles.

RADIO VOICE

Daniel, do you copy?

DANIEL

Lena? Yes. I'm here.

RADIO VOICE

The storm moved faster than expected. The fishing boats haven't returned.

Daniel looks toward the black horizon.

3. INT. LIGHTHOUSE — CONTROL ROOM — NIGHT

Maya enters the control room. Dust covers an old wooden desk. A framed photograph shows their father, TOM REYES, standing beside the lighthouse thirty years earlier.

Maya notices a small BRASS KEY taped behind the photograph.

MAYA

Dad's key.

She unlocks a narrow drawer. Inside is a handwritten LOGBOOK, a compass, and an old cassette recorder.

Maya presses PLAY. Her father's recorded voice fills the room.

TOM (V.O.)

If you're hearing this, the lantern has failed again. But the real problem is not the light.

Maya freezes.

4. INT. LIGHTHOUSE — CONTROL ROOM — LATER

Daniel enters, soaked and breathing hard.

DANIEL

Why didn't you answer me?

MAYA

I found Dad's logbook.

Daniel sees the photograph and goes silent.

DANIEL

You shouldn't have opened that drawer.

MAYA

Why? What did he hide?

DANIEL

(quietly)

The night he disappeared, he wasn't alone.

Thunder shakes the windows.

5. EXT. SEA WALL — NIGHT

A fishing boat struggles against enormous waves. On the deck, LENA PARK, 35, a harbor dispatcher, grips a handheld radio.

LENA

Bellhaven Lighthouse, this is Harbor Control. Respond.

Only static. The lighthouse beam suddenly goes DARK.

LENA

Oh no.

A wave crashes over the boat.

6. INT. LIGHTHOUSE — LANTERN ROOM — NIGHT

Maya and Daniel race upstairs. The lantern has stopped rotating.

MAYA

The motor isn't broken.

DANIEL

Then why did it stop?

Maya points to the floor. A thin trail of seawater leads toward a locked maintenance hatch.

MAYA

Someone opened that hatch.

Daniel pulls out a pocketknife and cuts the old chain.

CUT TO:

7. INT. LIGHTHOUSE — MAINTENANCE TUNNEL — NIGHT

The brothers descend into a cramped stone tunnel beneath the lighthouse. Maya leads with the flashlight. They find an old generator room. A FUEL CAN sits beside a modern battery pack.

DANIEL

Someone's been down here recently.

A FOOTSTEP echoes in the darkness.

MAYA

Who's there?

Silence. Maya discovers a second notebook hidden behind a pipe. The cover reads: TOM REYES — PRIVATE.

MAYA

This explains everything.

8. INT. LIGHTHOUSE — GENERATOR ROOM — NIGHT

Maya reads the notebook. Tom had discovered that smugglers were using the lighthouse as a signal station. He planned to expose them.

Daniel looks ashamed.

DANIEL

I knew part of it.

MAYA

You knew?

DANIEL

Dad told me to keep you away from this place.

The radio crackles from Daniel's pocket.

LENA (RADIO)

Daniel, there's a boat heading straight for the rocks!

Maya looks at the generator.

MAYA

Then we bring the light back.

9. INT. LIGHTHOUSE — GENERATOR ROOM — CONTINUOUS

Maya connects the battery pack to the emergency generator. Daniel turns a large steel valve.

The generator coughs once, then roars to life.

Maya runs upstairs.

10. INT. LIGHTHOUSE — LANTERN ROOM — CONTINUOUS

Maya reaches the lantern. She pulls the emergency lever.

The Fresnel lens begins turning. The beam cuts through the storm. Far offshore, the fishing boat changes course.

LENA (RADIO)

We see the light! We're clear!

Maya smiles. Daniel arrives beside her.

DANIEL

Dad would have been proud.

MAYA

He'd probably tell us to fix the motor properly.

They laugh for the first time.

11. EXT. LIGHTHOUSE — DAWN

The storm has passed. The sea is calm. The first sunlight touches Bellhaven.

Maya stands outside with the old logbook. Daniel joins her.

She looks back at the lighthouse. The lantern continues to turn.

MAYA

Some lights are meant to stay on.

Daniel nods.

FADE OUT.

THE END

Extraction targets: title, author, 11 scenes, characters, locations, props, dialogue, voice-over, radio dialogue, and scene transitions.